

Olivia Taylor-Gao

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EDUCATION - *University of California, Berkeley*

August 2023 – May 2027

BS in Environmental Economics and Policy, Cognitive Science, Minor Sustainable Business and Policy (Completed) GPA: 3.3

- **Relevant Coursework:** Examples – Computational Structures in Data Science, Psychology and Economics, Applied Econometrics, Principles of Business and Intermediate Microeconomics with Applications to Sustainability
- **Certifications:** Berkeley Student Leadership Academy Certificate, Berkeley Skydeck Certificate (Startup accelerator program)
- **Coursera:** Foundations of Project Management, AI Fundamentals for Non-Data Scientists, Work Smarter with Microsoft Excel
- **Awards:** **1st Place at Undergraduate Economics Association Case Competition** in 2025. **Runner-Up at the Girls Into VC @ Berkeley Summit Pitch Competition.** **SCET Student Innovation Fellow Silver Level - Fall 2024** **1st place at Berkeley's Spring 2024 EGAL Case Competition** (Increasing Awareness, Access & Inclusion in Innovation & Entrepreneurship at UC Berkeley) with a Team of 4. **2nd Place at Spring 2022 International Protégé Competition** in the Opera Singer category

WORK EXPERIENCE

Rooh - Startup Co-Founder

Jan 2025 – November 2025

- An AI-driven communication platform providing real-time, video and audio-based feedback to help users improve public speaking, presentation, and interpersonal communication skills. Selected for Skydeck Pad-13 and the Google Startups program.
- Designed product vision and UX around vocal imitation, audience engagement metrics, and timeline-based feedback.

Intuitive Surgical - Environmental Compliance Summer Intern

May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Performed climate risk analysis for multiple sites and created detailed process documentation, ensuring compliance with California and European climate risk disclosure laws and alignment with internal sustainability metrics.
- Conducted grid greening analyses and projections, evaluated renewable energy integration opportunities, and long-term energy transition impacts through data analysis and coding.
- Ensured MDR (Medical Device Regulation) compliance by creating records for audit readiness and regulatory reporting.

UC Berkeley, Rausser College of Natural Resources - (Research Assistant)

February 2025-May 2025

- Researched and analyzed the emerging biodiversity credit market, comparing different crediting schemes.

NewBeex - Market Research and Business Development

September 2024 - May 2025

- Designed the New Beex website and landing page, a new platform enabling people to build communities.
- Conducted market research and user interviews, developed questions, and leveraged insights to enhance the platform.

UC Berkeley, Sutardja Center for Entrepreneurship and Technology - Innovation Fellow

August 2024 - November 2024

- Ranked **9th out of 51 fellows** and earned **Silver Tier status** in a competitive entrepreneurship program.
- Created startup strategies through workshops and challenges while learning from industry experts.

UC Berkeley, Rausser College of Natural Resources - Research Assistant/Intern

May 2024 - August 2024

- Conducted comprehensive research on the East Coast fishing industry: thematically coded over 50 oral history interviews and consolidated data on climate adaptation strategies, moral economies, resource conflicts, demographic shifts, social dynamics, and the industry's transition to aquaculture.
- Highlighted 5 key critical areas of tension affecting the industry, fishermen, and surrounding communities.

Echandia (European battery provider for marine applications) - Business Development Intern

December 2023 - May 2024

- Researched the Trade Agreement Act and the Buy America and Build America Act (BABA) to determine the required manufacturing process for a successful entry into the North American market. Presented findings to the executive team.
- Worked with the engineering and sales teams to identify over 50 suitable manufacturing facilities and 15 potential eligible grants.
- Co-authored a press release with the Washington Governor's Office, announcing Echandia's plans for a Washington-based manufacturing facility. Developed North American marketing strategies targeting 15+ maritime groups. Revised trade show messaging to ensure it catered to all potential customers.

UC Berkeley Housing and Dining Sustainability - Intern

August 2023 - December 2023

- Implemented more effective sustainability initiatives on campus for over 1,000 students in dining halls, conducted surveys to assess engagement with these initiatives, conducted waste audits and cocreated sustainability training content for 100+ staff.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Berkeley Student Cooperative - Board Member

April 2025 - Present

- Serve on nonprofit board overseeing \$15M revenue and \$200M+ in assets; developed proposals to improve financial efficiency through cost reduction and operational optimization.

Berkeley Student Leadership Academy - Alumni Fellow

January 2024 - Present

- Presented workshops on Time Management and Branding for 100+ incoming Academy members. Spotlight BSLA participant.

UC Berkeley - Library Security Rover Work Leader

December 2023 - Present

- Ensured the safety of all patrons and employees by enforcing the Library Code of Conduct across the 4 main libraries on campus.

Berkeley Environmental Economics and Policy Society - Secretary

December 2023 - Present

- Organized all club events with team members and relaunched the club website. Marketed academic-themed events for 400+ members through Instagram, email listserver, and Slack, including professional development workshops and speaker events.

Berkeley Student Cooperative - Academic Coordinator

June 2024 - May 2025

- Hosted professor guest speakers and hosted the first-ever networking event at the house of Cloyne, connecting Berkeley students with Cloyne alumni. Created the "Cloyne Academic Resources Newsletter" and offered academic workshops to 100+ members.